The pattern `[abc]*` isn't particularly clever because of the * quantifier and would match empty sequences several times in the sample string we've used.

Finally, `mb_regex_set_options()` also permits different syntax modes, if you have a burning desire to not use Perl-flavored expressions (may the creator have mercy on your soul). This must be the final character in the options string, and of course, only a single mode is supported.

Table 8-39. *`mbstring` syntax modes*

`j`	Java
`u`	GNU
`g`	grep
`c`	Emacs
`r`	Ruby
`z`	Perl
`b`	POSIX Basic
`d`	POSIX Extended

And that concludes our journey into regular expressions. As mentioned, there is a wealth of material to be found online for learning about and testing your expressions. I can recommend the following:

- `https://regex101.com/` Build and test expressions with clear analysis of your patterns
- `https://www.rexegg.com/` Egg-cellent tutorials with clear examples

Happy pattern building!

Other Language Extensions

Before we close out this chapter, I just want to highlight some other potentially useful PHP extensions for string handling. There are two modules that you'll most likely encounter in your journey as a PHP developer: `iconv` and `intl`.